

Safety Alert SA-2026-04

Dropped object from height – high potential near miss

Hannah Weber · 05 June 2026 · SA-2026-04

Safety alert SA-2026-04 – please share at your next toolbox talk and confirm to HSE.

What happened

On 3 June 2026 (HSE-INC-2026-018) a 2.3 kg ratchet spanner fell about 22 m from the pile gripper frame of the installation vessel MV Sea Atlas at Harrow Bay. It deflected off a handrail and landed 2.5 m from a deck foreman. Nobody was injured.

IMAGE PLACEHOLDER

hse-tool-tethering

Close-up of a worker's gloved hands attaching a coiled tool lanyard to a heavy ratchet spanner, a tool belt with tethered tools on a steel platform, safety harness visible, offshore daylight.

Why it matters

An object of this weight falling from this height carries enough energy to kill, even through a helmet. Barriered drop zones do not protect you if objects deflect off structures.

What you must do

- Tether every hand tool when working at height – no exceptions, whatever the weight.
- Never place tools or parts on handrails, kick plates or ledges.
- Check that levels above are clear before moving or slewing any structure.
- Review your drop zones – consider deflection.
- Report every dropped object, even small ones.

Issued by Hannah Weber, HSE Manager, on 2026-06-05.